Storyboard

Telling stories is an excellent way of guiding people through a user experience. Storyboarding, a technique derived from the film industry, is something you can use for early prototyping to allow yourself to visualize the user's journey or how users would experience a problem or product. When you draw storyboards, try to imagine the complete user experience, and then capture it in a series of images or sketches.

Storyboarding, as a prototyping method, ensures that we know our users well enough (it would be hard to sketch a storyboard otherwise) and allows us to keep in mind the context of the solution we are designing. You should use a storyboard to develop an empathic understanding of users—and to generate high-level ideation and discussions. However, you shouldn't use storyboards to fine-tune the details of your products, because the drawings tend to focus on the big picture rather than small details.

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Best Practice

To create a storyboard, follow these steps:

1 **Start by considering:**

- Who your users are.
- What motivates them to use your product.
- What their use context is.

Your users will be your main characters. You don't have to draw at this point, just keep it in mind for when you create the drawing.

2 **Then you can start to think through your user journey:**

- How will the user learn about your product?
- How will they acquire it?
- What will it be like the first time they use it?
- What will their eventual user pattern be like?
- What will they get out of using your product?

3 Then it's time to draw the different points in your user journey. Turn it into a story where you not only explain what the user is doing, but also why they are doing it and what they feel about it. Always start your storyboard by introducing your main character and their motivations. You also need to create subtitles that explain what it going on in each of your drawings.

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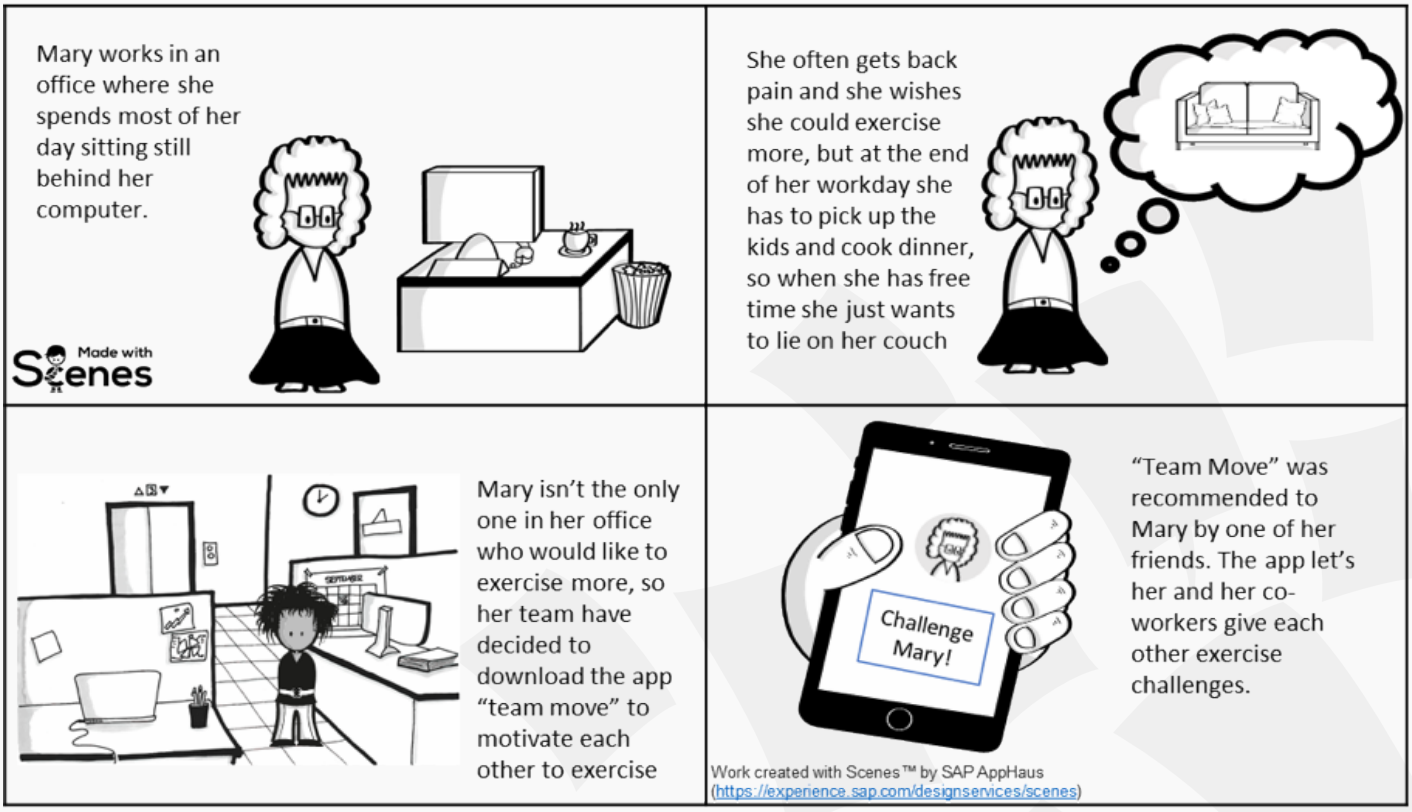
The following is an example of the beginning of a storyboard for an app that motivates people to workout at work. The full version would have more slides that detail how the app works and how it motivates the users.



You may use the storyboard template on the next page to illustrate your user stories!

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Storyboard Template

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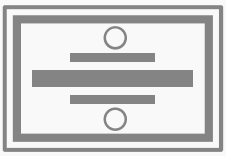

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